

now took half of his income) or his spending (which took more than half) would be a lack of “faith.”

His scriptural justification was that God said we must “believe” and whatever we ask for in faith will be ours (Matthew 21:22).

His friend called and asked if we could meet with Dave. He knew something was wrong with that logic, but he wasn’t sure what it was.

When we met with Dave, I shared what I perceived to be the bottom line.

(1) The business was dropping rapidly (although through no fault of Dave’s).

(2) It didn’t appear there would be a near-term turnaround.

(3) Dave was maintaining his living and giving at the expense of his creditors.

(4) All the faith Dave talked about would seem to be on the part of the creditors.

I also shared that God will not give us direction that would require a violation of His Word. And according to God’s Word, at least three basic principles applied:

(1) A lender is an authority over a borrower (Proverbs 22:7).

(2) We are to give honor to our authority (Romans 13:1).

(3) Only the wicked borrow and do not repay (Psalm 37:21).

Dave disagreed and refused to alter his position. A year later his business failed, and he lost his home and virtually every other asset.

DANGER SIGN: OVERCOMMITMENT

Of all the problems that cause financial friction, probably none is more disheartening to a wife than a husband overcommitted to his work. Many women have said to me, “How can I compete with my husband’s work? He’s totally consumed by it.” Unfortunately, it’s true. Many men, and more recently, women, are so wrapped up in their work that they have little or no time for their families.